
Mid-Back and Rib Cage

Companion Workbook — fill it in as you go

NATE RATCLIFF, LMT

Mid-Back and Rib Cage

Companion Workbook — fill it in as you
go

NATE RATCLIFF, LMT

HEALING HANDS BY NATE

Mid-Back and Rib Cage

© 2026 Healing Hands By Nate. All rights reserved.

Nate Ratcliff, LMT

Continuity Member Edition — Month 8 Workbook

For Healing Hands By Nate members. Personal use only. Please don't redistribute — share the membership instead.

Published by Healing Hands By Nate

Contents

1. How to use this workbook
2. Where You Are Today
3. Reflection Prompts
4. 7-Day Mid-Back Open-Up Tracker
5. End-of-Week Reflection
6. Try this for 7 days

Introduction

A PRINTABLE COMPANION TO THE MONTH 8
module. Fill it in as you go.

CHAPTER 1

How to use this workbook

PRINT IT. KEEP IT WHERE YOU'LL DO THE WORK — bedroom floor, living room, whatever space you stretch in.

The mid-back is the area that responds fastest to consistent attention. This workbook is built to help you notice the changes as they happen, because they happen quickly and you'll forget how stuck you used to feel.

Bring it to your next session.

CHAPTER 2

Where You Are Today

DO A QUICK MOBILITY SELF-TEST BEFORE **starting anything**. Stand up. Feet shoulder-width apart. Hands crossed over your chest.

Without moving your hips, **rotate your upper body slowly to the right** as far as you comfortably can. Note where you end up — can you see directly behind you? Halfway behind you?

Now rotate to the left.

Now stand normally. Try to **arch backward gently** — chin up, chest forward, shoulders back. Where do you feel the bend? In your mid-back, or only in your low back and neck?

Record:

- Rotation to the right: I can see [] my front shoulder / [] over my shoulder / [] partway behind me / [] fully behind me
- Rotation to the left: I can see [] my front shoulder / [] over my shoulder / [] partway behind me / [] fully behind me
- Backward bend: I feel it mostly in my [] mid-back / [] low back / [] neck / [] nowhere — can't bend back

Rate each symptom (0 = none, 10 = severe):

Neck stiffness	[_____]
Between-shoulder-blade tightness	[_____]
Shallow breathing / can't catch breath	[_____]
Shoulder tension	[_____]
Low back rotation pain	[_____]
"Hunched" feeling at end of day	[_____]

Three honest sentences about your upper body right now:

1.

2.

3.

CHAPTER 3

Reflection Prompts

PROMPT 1: WHEN YOU TAKE YOUR DEEPEST breath of the day, what moves? Belly only? Chest only? Both? Neither (it just stays shallow)?

Prompt 2: Think about the last time you turned around quickly — to look behind you while backing the car up, or to react to something. Did your whole body rotate or did your neck do all the work?

Prompt 3: If the mid-back is “where your body stores everything it can’t process,” what do you suspect yours might be carrying?

CHAPTER 4

7-Day Mid-Back Open-Up Tracker

FOR THE NEXT WEEK, DO THE 10-MINUTE DAILY routine and check in below.

Check pattern (use for each day)

- Did I do all 3 moves today? (cat-cow / open-book / foam roller) — circle each that you did
- Which one felt the most restrictive? (the most “stuck”)
- How’s my breathing right now? (1 = shallow, 10 = full and deep)
- How does my upper body feel right now? (1 word)

Day 1 — Date: ____

Moves done: cat-cow / open-book / foam roller

Most restrictive: _____

Breathing (1-10): [__] / **Upper body (one word):**

Day 2 — Date: _____

Moves done: cat-cow / open-book / foam roller

Most restrictive: _____

Breathing (1-10): [__] / **Upper body (one word):**

Day 3 — Date: _____

Moves done: cat-cow / open-book / foam roller

Most restrictive: _____

Breathing (1-10): [__] / **Upper body (one word):**

Day 4 — Date: _____

Moves done: cat-cow / open-book / foam roller

Most restrictive: _____

Breathing (1-10): [__] / **Upper body (one word):**

Day 5 — Date: _____

Moves done: cat-cow / open-book / foam roller

Most restrictive: _____

Breathing (1-10): [__] / **Upper body (one word):**

Day 6 — Date: _____

Moves done: cat-cow / open-book / foam roller

Most restrictive: _____

Breathing (1-10): [__] / **Upper body (one word):**

Day 7 — Date: _____

Moves done: cat-cow / open-book / foam roller

Most restrictive: _____

Breathing (1-10): [__] / **Upper body (one word):**

CHAPTER 5

End-of-Week Reflection

RE-DO THE MOBILITY SELF-TEST FROM THE beginning. Compare.

Rotation right: I can now see [] my front shoulder / [] over my shoulder / [] partway behind / [] fully behind

Rotation left: I can now see [] my front shoulder / [] over my shoulder / [] partway behind / [] fully behind

Backward bend: I now feel it in my [] mid-back / [] low back / [] neck

Re-rate each symptom (0-10):

Neck stiffness	[____]
(Day 1: [____])	
Between-shoulder-blade tightness	[____]
(Day 1: [____])	
Shallow breathing	[____]
(Day 1: [____])	
Shoulder tension	[____]
(Day 1: [____])	
"Hunched" feeling at end of day	[____]
(Day 1: [____])	

What changed?

Which move worked best for your body?

- ☐ Cat-cow
- ☐ Open-book stretch
- ☐ Foam roller extension

One commitment for next week:

I will

CHAPTER 6

Try this for 7 days

IF YOU DO NOTHING ELSE FROM THIS WORKBOOK, try this:

Open-book stretch. 5 reps each side. Once in the morning, once before bed. Every day for one week.

That's the assignment. Two minutes a day. Two times a day.

The mid-back is the area that responds fastest to consistent attention. Most people see real change in a week with this one move alone. If you only do one thing, do this one.

Bring this workbook to your next session. I want to see what your rotation looks like after a week.

— Nate



This book was crafted by Nate Ratcliff,
LMT and published by Healing Hands By
Nate.